

General Lit.





About the Course

Journey into the 19th century via novels, short stories, personal narratives, fairy tales, and more. Students engage with a variety of authors and texts from and about the time period and reflect on literary techniques and the characteristics of multiple genres along the way.

This topic is included in the following course(s): Literature: Grade 11, Literature: Grade 12



Placement & Combining Tips

Some books shared with other high school grades. Literature, history, and geography lessons work in sync in Grades 9-12, so it is best to consider all three together when placing students.



Scheduling

GRADE	SCHEDULE INFO.	BOOKS
11-12	General Lit.: Grades 11-12 2 times/week 30 min	Narrative of the Life of Frederick Douglass Up from Slavery James Jane Eyre The Count of Monte Cristo Short stories and other writings Things Fall Apart The Souls of Black Folk

Sample Weekly View

Day 1	Day 2	Day 3	Day 4	Day 5
Literature: Grade 11				
History of Lit: Grades 9-12 Poetry Study: Grade 11	Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12	General Lit.: Grades 11-12 Poetry Study: Grade 11	Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12	General Lit.: Grades 11-12 Plays: Grades 9-12
Literature: Grade 12				
History of Lit: Grades 9-12		General Lit.: Grades 11-12	Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12	General Lit.: Grades 11-12 Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12 Plays: Grades 9-12



Planning & Prep

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LINKS: Click text or scan the QR code in the top corner of the lesson plan pages to view online resources associated with the lessons.

Responsibility for previewing all links rests with the teacher. All links were checked at the time of publication; however, websites change frequently and may contain objectionable content. Please report broken links by contacting us through our website.

General Lit.: Grades 11-12

□ The Scarlet Letter (Term 1) and Sense & Sensibility (Term 3) both have helpful introductions and discussion questions (listed after each chapter or section of the book). Read these, whether or not you are able to read the full book, to give yourself the resources for rich discussions with your students. Reading Like a Serpent (linked in Extra Helpings) is also an excellent resource for students and teachers wishing to dive deeper into The Scarlet Letter.

□ A note on challenging content: While the upper grades provide many wonderful opportunities for discussion and growth, these are not children's books. The Scarlet Letter (Term 1) wrestles with the nature of sin and adultery, Ramayana (Term 1) includes a more overtly sexual myth, which is skipped in Ch.1, and a few more sexual comments in Ch.2 when the prince (in typical mythological fashion) passes a test to claim his wife. Singing Bird (Term 2) also has a brief description of a sexual encounter in Ch.21 intended to humanize the characters in the middle of a horrific situation. Similarly, there is a passage in Octavian Nothing (Term 2), early in section 2, "The Pox Party," where Octavian (who is hungry for good books to read) is coerced into translating sexually explicit Latin texts in return for smuggled books from his master's library. There is one example of a sentence he was asked to translate given in the book, and he is disgusted with it. Additionally, prepare your students for hard themes, especially in Singing Bird and Octavian Nothing, including slavery, war, and the cruel and abusive treatment of people and animals. It is sobering to consider wickedness and suffering; encourage students to grieve, and long for and look to the person who can put things right, Jesus, who brings perfect justice and love.

These books have many living ideas, examples of incredible resilience, and more. But it is a good idea to plan to read and/or discuss these books alongside your student(s), especially since they may be assigned much harder texts, or texts from a much less morally aligned perspective in college classes, when they will need to know how to approach these situations wisely on their own without you there to guide them.

□ One way to approach conversations about content is to ask your student their thoughts on the section or chapter with the sexual or violent content and bring up the fact that they might not have encountered something like it before. Then, ask why they think the author included it in the book. Or, you might discuss the importance of skimming over something.

□ Term 3 reads are both long novels. Especially for Tale of Two Cities, allow students time to narrate and enjoy the story; only about half is scheduled over the term. If you want to finish the book, start it in Term 2 after Gulliver's Travels, or allow students to read on their own time and use the allotted lesson time for extended written narrations and reflection.



Books & Resources

For book rationales and purchase options, click the Book List link or scan the QR code below.

∞ [View Book List Details](#)

General Lit.: Grades 11-12



Narrative of the Life of Frederick Douglass



Up from Slavery



James



Jane Eyre



The Count of Monte Cristo

Short stories and other writings



Things Fall Apart



The Souls of Black Folk



Supplies

For supply list details and basic supplies helpful to have on hand, click the links or scan the QR code below.

∞ [View Basic Supplies](#)

(No Subject Supplies Assigned)



Quick Links

(No Quick Links Assigned)

[Click THIS text
or scan the QR
code for links.](#)



General Lit.: Grades 11-12

How To Approach



Read

The lesson plans will guide you through what to read over the terms. Take a moment before reading to remember where you left off last time.



Narrate

The lesson plans will give you specific instructions or tell you to choose a way to narrate that helps you interact with the ideas.



Discuss

The lesson plans will guide you with questions or instructions to share your ideas or what you are reading with others.



Teacher Note

These lessons are written directly to students, but to assist them throughout the year, please read through this section and the lesson plans so you are familiar with the instructions and flow of the lessons. Accountability components are occasionally added to facilitate teacher/student discussion and growing independence.

It is also valuable for those in a classroom setting to have a mix of lessons that students complete themselves silently and others read aloud and narrate together. Literature lessons lend themselves well to a larger discussion time at the end of the lesson where student can share their ideas.

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Term 3

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WEEK 12 ☐ 30m General Lit.: Grades 11-12 - Lesson 71

WEEK 12 ☐ 30m General Lit.: Grades 11-12 - Lesson 72